JJO Talent Hunt 2026

Rules & Regulations

Event Details

Organizer: Jhale Jhole Ombole (JJO) (Tristate Bengali Cultural Association (501c3))
Venue: Hillsborough Middle School, 260 Triangle Rd, Hillsborough Township, NJ 08844
Date: Saturday, May 9th, 2026
Time: 12:30 PM - 8:30 PM (*category-wise schedule will be shared separately*)
Registration Fee: $10 per participant (per category)
Audience Entry: FREE (Parents/Guardians/Siblings/Grandparents)
Registration Link: To be shared

Age Groups

Participants will compete in the following groups:

- Group A: 6 - 10 years
- Group B: 11 - 16 years

Participants must register in the correct age group and carry valid proof of age.

Competition Categories:

- Singing
- Dancing (Indian Styles)
- Instrumental Music
- Drawing / Painting
- Recitation (*Bengali Only*)
- Monologue (*English*)
- Script Writing (*English)*

Judging & Selection Process (Two-Round System)

Round 1 - On-Site Judging (New Jersey)

- Performances will be evaluated by judges from New Jersey
- The top 6 participants from each category & age group will be shortlisted

Round 2 - Celebrity Judges (Kolkata, India)

- Shortlisted performances will be reviewed by eminent judges from Kolkata
- The top 3 winners will be selected in each category & age group

Final Recognition

- The Top 3 winners in each category & age group will receive:
    - Certificates & recognition
    - A personalized video message from the Celebrity Judge (to be showcased at all **JJO Social Platforms**, and on **JJO 2026 Cultural Bridge - Aug 1st, 2026**)
    - Opportunity to perform at future JJO events
    - Potential participation in curated cultural showcases

General Rules (Applicable to All)

1. Participants may enter **multiple categories** (separate registration required)
2. Content, Costume, and Presentation must be **age-appropriate**.
3. **Report at least 45 minutes before** their scheduled time.
4. **Time limits are strictly enforced** (see category rules below).
5. **The judges' decision will be final and binding.**
6. Any **pre-recorded or AI-generated performance content** (music/voice) will result in the participant's cancellation from the category.
7. Participants must bring their **own props, instruments, and materials**.
8. Organizers will provide a **basic sound system only (mic + AUX/Bluetooth)**.
9. **No last-minute category changes** will be allowed.
10. JJO reserves the right to **adjust category specific schedule/order or cancel the category without citing reason** if required.

Category-wise Rules

Singing

- Includes Modern Bengali, Rabindra Sangeet, Bhajan (Bengali/Hindi), Classical (Bengali/Hindi). Lyrics should be age-appropriate.
- Time Limit: 3 minutes
- Karaoke track allowed (USB/phone). Has to be submitted at the reporting time.
- No lip-syncing
- Will be judged based on 'Sur', 'Taal', Emotion, pronunciation, and the difficulty level of the chosen song.

Instrumental Music

- Participants must bring their own instruments
- Time Limit:
  - Group A: 3 minutes
  - Group B: 5 minutes
- Solo performance only

Dancing (Indian Styles)

- Includes Bharatanatyam, Odishi, Kathak, Rabindra Nritya, Folk, etc.
- Time Limit: 3 minutes
- Music/lyric must be kid-appropriate
- Track to be submitted in advance (MP3 preferred)
- The theme will be announced on the spot

Drawing / Painting

- Participants must bring their own materials. JJO can only provide basic color pens. Drawing Sheets will be provided by JJO.
- Time Limit:
  - Group A: 45 minutes
  - Group B: 90 minutes
- Only individual work is allowed

Recitation (Bengali)

- The Language should be in Bengali
- The choice of Poems should be age-appropriate.
- No reading from paper/digital media
- Time Limit: Max 3 minutes
- Clear pronunciation and expression will be judged

Monologue (English)

Collect the script after registration. Must be memorized (no reading from paper)
Time Limit: Max 3 minutes
Props allowed but optional

Script Writing (English):

Dialog-based original work. Max 4-6 characters with a max duration of 20-25 minutes of performance. Max 2000 words. Has to be submitted by the due date: **9th May, 2026**

Overall Judging Criteria

Participants will be evaluated on:

- Creativity & originality
- Presentation & confidence
- Technique & skill
- Expression & stage presence
- Adherence to rules and time

Disqualification Clauses

- Exceeding the time limit significantly
- Inappropriate content
- Misrepresentation of age
- Plagiarism (for writing category)